

BB84

attenuated laser: one photon per pulse



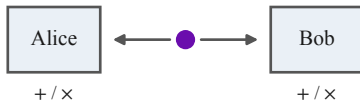
bit is fixed at the source

check: QBER

a split photon already
carries a determined bit

BBM92

source in the middle: each arm $L/2$



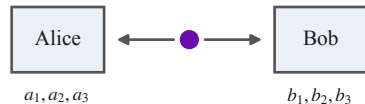
source at Alice: Bob's arm carries all of L

check: QBER

no key exists until
both parties measure

E91

entangled pair source



matched angles $\rightarrow$ key

mismatched angles $\rightarrow$ measure S

check: CHSH value S

certifies entanglement,
not the error rate